NO BIG CORPORATE BRAND ON THE RESUME: CAN PROFESSIONAL IMPACT MATTER MORE?

CASE STUDY STRATEGY WORKSHEET: PRIYA MENON | MBA PROFILE BUILDING

1. Student Persona & Challenge Diagnostic Audit

Candidate: Priya Menon | Profile: Operations professional, 5 years at a mid-sized Indian company.. This worksheet outlines the systematic forensic diagnostic and strategic intervention designed to resolve this admissions roadblock.

Assessment Dimension	Diagnostic Finding & Initial Challenge	Strategic Objective
Candidate Profile	Operations professional, 5 years at a mid-sized Indian company.	Build differentiated application proposition
Core Admissions Roadblock	Priya believed that applicants from multinational companies had an advantage over her. Her employer was relatively small, and she worried th...	Eliminate systemic bottlenecks through data feedback
Root Cause Identified	Misalignment between effort and strategic execution	Shift from generic repetition to targeted intervention
Admissions Target	Competitive Global / Indian MBA Program	Maximize admit ROI and scholarship potential

Key Diagnostic Insight:

"A high test score or strong resume alone is not a substitute for a coherent admissions story. Every applicant requires a personalized roadmap that aligns quantitative readiness with distinctive leadership impact." — Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee)

2. Step-by-Step Strategic Intervention

- Evaluated her actual responsibilities and decision-making authority.
- Identified projects where she improved business operations.
- Quantified cost savings and efficiency improvements where evidence existed.
- Identified cross-functional collaboration and leadership examples.
- Developed a narrative around her contribution rather than employer reputation.

3. Actionable Checklist for MBA Applicants

- Diagnostic First: Never increase preparation hours or rewrite essays without an objective diagnostic baseline.
- Data-Driven Tracking: Use targeted analytics to monitor error patterns rather than counting raw study hours.
- Holistic Narrative: Connect undergraduate background, career progression, and MBA goals into one cohesive arc.
- Expert Perspective: Involve senior mentors early to eliminate blind spots and stress-test interview responses.
- Advice: A preparation strategy must fit your reality. Consistency always beats sporadic marathons.

Wondering whether your work experience is competitive? Get your professional profile assessed.

Schedule a 1-on-1 strategy session with Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee) at www.mbawizards.co.in